

LUKAS J. GUNSCHERA

MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit
University of Cambridge
United Kingdom

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EDUCATION

University of Cambridge – MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit
PhD, Medical Science

From Oct 2023
Cambridge, UK

Research using computational, longitudinal, psychopharmacological, experimental, clinical, and qualitative approaches to examine social media ‘addiction’ and whether problematic social media use is underpinned by the neurocognitive mechanisms of addiction.

University of Amsterdam
Master of Science, Psychological Research (cum laude)

Sep 2020 – Sep 2022
Amsterdam, The Netherlands

Radboud University
Bachelor of Science (Honours), Psychology (cum laude)

Sep 2017 – Sep 2020
Nijmegen, The Netherlands

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

University of Cambridge – MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit
Postgraduate Research Assistant (full time)

Oct 2022 – Oct 2023
Cambridge, UK

Research on the mental health impacts of digital technologies using large social media datasets and advanced computational and longitudinal methods.

Supervision: Amy Orben & Camilla Nord.

University of Oxford
Research Assistant (part time)

Nov 2021 – Nov 2022
Oxford, UK

Research on selective attention and learning deficits in psychopathic individuals and potential downstream consequences. *Supervision: Elaine Fox & Robin Murphy.*

University of Amsterdam
Teaching Assistant (part time)

Sep 2021 – Oct 2022
Amsterdam, The Netherlands

University of Amsterdam
Research Assistant (part time)

Feb 2021 – Dec 2022
Amsterdam, The Netherlands

Worked in multiple research groups at the university and was involved in all aspects of the research process. Notable contributions include co-leading a large longitudinal collaboration. *Supervision: Bruno Verschuere & Sanne de Wit.*

VISITING POSITIONS AND PLACEMENTS

University of Rotterdam
Visiting Researcher

Jun 2024 – Jun 2024
Rotterdam, The Netherlands

University of Oxford
Visiting Researcher

Oct 2019 – Nov 2019
Oxford, UK

Radboud University
Honours Programme, Interdisciplinary Honours Programme

Jan 2018 – Sep 2020
Nijmegen, The Netherlands

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

**** = shared senior authorship, * = equal contribution**

Gunschera, L.J., Dutton, K., Fox, E., Temple-McCune, A., Murphy, R. (2024). Overburdening associations: The dependency of psychopathy-related acquisitional learning deficits on processing load. *Personality and Individual Differences*. doi.org/10.1016/j.paid.2024.112705

Van der Cruyssen, I., Ben-Shakhar, G., Pertzov, Y., Guy, N., Cabooter, Q., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Verschuere, B. (2024). *Behavioural Research Methods*. doi.org/10.3758/s13428-023-02221-2

Gunschera, L.J., Verschuere, B., Murphy, R., Temple-McCune, A., Dutton, K., Fox, E. (2023). No impaired integration in psychopathy: Evidence from an illusory conjunction paradigm. *Personality Disorders: Theory, Research, and Treatment*. doi.org/10.1037/per0000619.

Gunschera, L.J., Brazil, I.A., Driessen, J.M.A. (2022). Socio-economic decision-making and psychopathy: A systematic review and meta-analysis. *Neuroscience and Biobehavioural Reviews*. 10.1016/j.neubiorev.2022.104966

Gunschera, L.J., Mehrhof, S.Z., Veith, C., Ong, E., Davidson, B.C., Vuorre, M., Nord, C.L., Orben, A. (2026). Does social media use show established neurocognitive signatures of addiction? *PsyArxiv*. doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/2eqs8_v1

Davidson, B.C., Turner, G., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Orben, A. (2026). Social media reward sensitivity and depressive symptoms over time. *PsyArxiv*. doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/8e3ar_v1

Turner, G., Valdez, C., **Gunschera, L.J.***, Valdez, C., Anderson, I.*, Brufal, Z.*, Dillmann, S.*, Fassi, L.*, Monarca, I.*, Ramirez, O.P.*, Tentori, M., Orben, A. (2026). Relating smartphone ‘app-journeys’ to mental health: A novel network analysis approach. *PsyArxiv*. doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/uytfr_v1

Gunschera, L.J., Achterberg, M., Speyer, L.G., Wise, T., Orben, A. (2025). Cognitive phenotypes of risk and resilience for the relationship between social media and mental health. *PsyArxiv*. doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/bgqyj_v1.

Davidson, B.C., Turner, G., Palminteri, S., Tomova, L., Eichstaedt, J.C., Salecha, A., Subrahmanya, S., Orben, A.**, **Gunschera, L.J.**** (2025). Prolonged social isolation is associated with increased behavioural sensitivity to ‘likes’ on social media. *PsyArxiv*. doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/65tdz_v1.

Turner, G., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Subrahmanya, S., Salecha, A., Eichstaedt, J.C., Palminteri, S., Orben, A. (in press). A computational model of reward learning and habits on social media. *PsyArxiv*. doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/xe25k.

Ferguson, A., Richards, M., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Mutak, A., Goldberg, R., Modecki, K., Orben, A. (in press). Digital parenting in the 21st century: Development and validation of a new digital parenting scale.

de Wit, S., Bieleke, M., Fletcher, P.C., Horstmann, A., Schueler, J., Brinkhof, L.P., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Murre, J.M.J. (2022). How long does it take to form a habit?: A multi-centre replication. *PCI Registered Reports Stage 1 acceptance*. <https://rr.peercommunityin.org/PCIRegisteredReports/articles/rec?id=210>

EVIDENCE FOR POLICY

Written Evidence

Orben, A., Purba, A.K., Fokas, I., **Gunschera, L.J.** et al. (2025). Feasibility Study of Methods and Data to Understand the Impact of Smartphones and Social Media on Children and Young People. *UK Department for Science, Innovation and Technology*. <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/understand-the-impact-of-smartphones-and-social-media-on-children-and-young-people/understand-the-impact-of-smartphones-and-social-media-on-children-and-young-people-executive-summary>

Gunschera, L.J., Orben, A., Turner, G. (2024). Addressing Gaps in Digital Media Research: Pathways for Future Science and Policy. *European Joint Research Commission Report*. <https://publications.jrc.ec.europa.eu/repository/handle/JRC143343>

Orben, A., **Gunschera, L.J.**, Turner, G. (2023). Written evidence for Initiative to protect youth mental health, safety, and privacy online. *National Telecommunications and Information Administration*. NTIA-2023-0008-0001

Oral Evidence

Addressing gaps in digital media research: Pathways for future science and policy, European Commission, Mar 2025, *Online*

Roundtable on Call for Evidence on Researchers’ access to information from regulated online services, Ofcom, Nov 2024, London, UK

AWARDS AND RECOGNITIONS

UK Research and Innovation Medical Research Council Studentship	Oct 2023 – Sep 2027
Cambridge Philosophical Society, Travel Grant	April 2026
Cambridge Philosophical Society, Travel Grant	May 2025
Wolfson College, Travel & Research Award	May 2025
British Association for Psychopharmacology, Bursary	May 2025
Wolfson College, Travel & Research Award	May 2024
American Psychological Association, Editor’s Choice Award	Mar 2023
Thesis Award, Netherlands Institute of Psychologists	Mar 2023

INVITED TALKS AND PRESENTATIONS

Rethinking social media addiction: The importance of mechanisms of diagnosis and treatment Royal College of Psychiatrists: Faculty of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry annual conference	Sep 2025 Manchester, UK
Cognitive phenotypes of risk and resilience for the relationship between social media and mental health Gillan Lab, Trinity College Dublin	Sep 2024 Online
Cognitive processes linking social media and mental health CERES, Jacobs Foundation	Sep 2024 Newport Beach, USA
Cognitive phenotypes of social media risk and resilience SO-REBEL and SYNC research groups, University of Rotterdam	Jun 2024 Rotterdam, The Netherlands
No impaired integration in psychopathy Personality disorder and addiction conference	Mar 2023 Utrecht, The Netherlands
Do psychopaths suffer from impaired information integration? Netherlands Institute of Psychologists	Feb 2023 Online

LECTURES AND TEACHING

Open Science: A beginners guide Cambridge Access to Mental Health & Psychology Programme	Aug 2025 Online
Improving Scientific Practices in Cognitive Science: Robust Statistics University of Cambridge, MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit	From 2024 Cambridge, UK
Improving Scientific Practices in Cognitive Science: Computational Reproducibility University of Cambridge, MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit	From 2024 Cambridge, UK
Social and Developmental Psychology University of Cambridge, Girton College	2024 Cambridge, UK
Meta-Analysis University of Amsterdam	2022 Amsterdam, The Netherlands
Scientific Writing and Presenting University of Amsterdam	2022 Amsterdam, The Netherlands
Addiction and Compulsive Disorders University of Amsterdam	2021 Amsterdam, The Netherlands

CONFERENCE PANELS AND WORKSHOPS

Panels

Adolescents in the wild web: bringing order to chaos through research <i>Royal College of Psychiatrists: Faculty of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry Annual Conference</i>	Sep 2025 Manchester, UK
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Workshops

A shared responsibility: Improving causal literacy across the scientific pipeline <i>Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science</i>	Jun 2023 Padova, Italy
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SUPERVISION AND TRAINING RECORD

Research Assistants and Interns

Jamil Adjallah	From 2025
Ioanna Fokas (next destination: MD at University of Warwick)	From 2024
Brandon Davidson (next destination: PhD at University of Cambridge)	From 2024
Emily Poort (next destination: PhD at Amsterdam UMC)	2022
Gustaw Opielka (next destination: PhD at University of Amsterdam)	2022

Graduate Students

Clelia Veith (Technical University of Munich)	From 2025
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Undergraduate Students

Ruxandra Ursache (University of Cambridge)	2025 – 2026
James D'Silva (University of Cambridge)	2025 – 2026
Ethan Ong (next destination: Deloitte Singapore)	2024 – 2025

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Notes on Science Co-Founder	From 2024 <i>Cambridge, UK</i>
Cambridge Access to Mental Health & Psychology Programme Supervisor & Lecturer	2024 – 2026 <i>Cambridge, UK</i>
Pint of Science Organising Member	2024 <i>Cambridge, UK</i>
Open Science Day MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit Co-Organiser	Mar 2024 <i>Cambridge, UK</i>

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit Open Science Committee, Chair	From 2025
Society for the Study of Addiction, Member	From 2025
British Psychological Society, Member	From 2025
British Association for Psychopharmacology, Member	From 2024
Wolfson College, Member	From 2023
Cambridge Philosophical Society, Member	From 2023
Cambridge Union, Member	From 2023
MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit Open Science Committee, Member	From 2022
Cambridge Journal of Science and Policy, Editor	2023 – 2025
Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science, Member	2023 – 2024
Psychonomic Society, Member	2022 – 2024
Society for Applied Research in Memory & Cognition, Member	2022 – 2024
Student Initiative for Open Science, Member	2021 – 2022
University of Amsterdam, Student Delegate	2020 – 2022

SKILLS

Programming	R, Stan, Git, jsPsych, SQL, MPLUS, Python, Docker, Inquisit, Lotus
Data acquisition	Electroencephalography, electrodermal, electrocardiography, respiration, eye-tracking, ecological momentary assessment
Formal Analyses	Bayesian inference, computational modeling, multilevel modeling, longitudinal modeling, structural equation modeling, meta-analysis

May 4th, 2026

